



**JABATAN PEMBANGUNAN KEMAHIRAN
KEMENTERIAN SUMBER MANUSIA
ARAS 7 & 8 BLOK D4, KOMPLEK D
PUSAT PENTADBIRAN KERAJAAN PERSEKUTUAN
62530 PUTRAJAYA**

KERTAS PENERANGAN
(INFORMATION SHEET)

KOD DAN NAMA PROGRAM / <i>PROGRAM'S CODE AND NAME</i>	Z-009-4: 2015 CORE ABILITIES	
TAHAP / LEVEL	4 (FOUR)	
NO. DAN TAJUK KEMAHIRAN TERAS / <i>CORE ABILITY NO. AND TITLE</i>	CA05 STRATEGIC THINKING SKILL	
NO. DAN PENYATAAN KEMAHIRAN / <i>ABILITY NO. AND STATEMENT</i>	05.01 ADVOCATE EFFECTIVE THINKING 05.02 COMPLY WITH EFFECTIVE ANALYSIS 05.03 APPLY STRESS MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUES 05.04 APPLY BUDGETARY CONTROL PROCEDURES 05.05 APPLY PROBLEM SOLVING TECHNIQUES	
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TAJUK/TITLE: STRESS MANAGEMENT TECHNIQUE

TUJUAN/PURPOSE:

This information sheet is intended to describe the requirement to create a stress free work environment in workplace. The person who is competent in this CA shall be able to reduce stress at work, aside from the obvious humanitarian and ethical considerations.

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PENERANGAN/INFORMATION:

1. Causes Lead To Stress

1.1 : Employers should provide a stress-free work environment, recognise where stress is becoming a problem for staff, and take action to reduce stress. Stress in the workplace reduces productivity, increases management pressures, and makes people ill in many ways. Workplace stress affects the performance of the brain, including functions of work performance; memory, concentration, and learning. Through surveys, stress is believed to trigger 70% of visits to doctors, and 85% of serious illnesses. Stress at work also provides a serious risk of litigation for all employers and organisations, carrying significant liabilities for damages, bad publicity and loss of reputation. Dealing with stress-related claims also consumes vast amounts of management time.

1.2 : Whatever kind of job is involved in, you would always find several factors that lead to severe stress. It isn't easy to point on just one or two causes of stress. There are several factors that could contribute towards a person suffering from all sorts of stress. You must understand what causes stress if you are to efficiently try and reduce stress from your lifestyle.

1.3 : Everyone has different stress triggers. According to the surveys, work stress is the biggest source of stress in our lives. Causes of work stress include:-

- i) Being unhappy in your job
- ii) Having a heavy workload or too much responsibility
- iii) Working long hours
- iv) Having poor management, unclear expectations of your work, or no say in the decision-making process
- v) Working under dangerous conditions
- vi) Being insecure about your chance for advancement or risk of termination
- vii) Having to give speeches in front of colleagues
- viii) Facing discrimination or harassment at work, especially if your company isn't supportive.

1.4 : Life stresses are other reasons that could contribute to individual suffering from severe stress outside the workplace. Examples of life stresses are:

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- i) The death of a loved one
- ii) Divorce
- iii) Loss of a job
- iv) Increase in financial obligations
- v) Getting married
- vi) Moving to a new home
- vii) Chronic illness or injury
- viii) Emotional problems (depression, anxiety, anger, grief, guilt, low self-esteem)
- ix) Taking care of an elderly or sick family member
- x) Traumatic event, such as a natural disaster, theft, rape, or violence against you or a loved one

1.5 : Sometimes the stress comes from inside, rather than outside. You can stress just by worrying about things. These inner stress factors can lead to :

- i) Fear and uncertainty. When you regularly hear about the robberies, snatch thieves, global warming, and toxic chemicals on the news, it can cause you to be stressed. Fears can also hit closer to home, such as being worried that you won't finish a project at work or won't have enough money to pay your bills this month.
- ii) Attitudes and perceptions. How you view a particular situation can determine whether it causes stress. For example, if your television set is stolen and you take the attitude not to bother about it, you'll be far less stressed. Similarly, people who doing a good job at workplace will be less stressed than those who are incompetent.
- iii) Unrealistic expectations. No one is perfect. If you expect to do everything right all the time, you're destined to feel stressed when things don't go as expected.
- iv) Change. Any major life change can be stressful. Most unpleasant events, such as a divorce, major financial setback, or death in the family can be significant sources of stress.

1.6 : Your stress level will differ based on your personality and how you respond to situations. Some people let everything roll off their back. To them, work stresses and life stresses are just minor bumps in the road.

1.7 : Failure to understand and eliminate these elements that cause the stress could

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eventually lead to dire consequences. These elements are generally known as stressors and are found in plenty in the workplace. It is not only the employees,

who need to identify these stressors, but also the organization itself would need to take relevant steps.

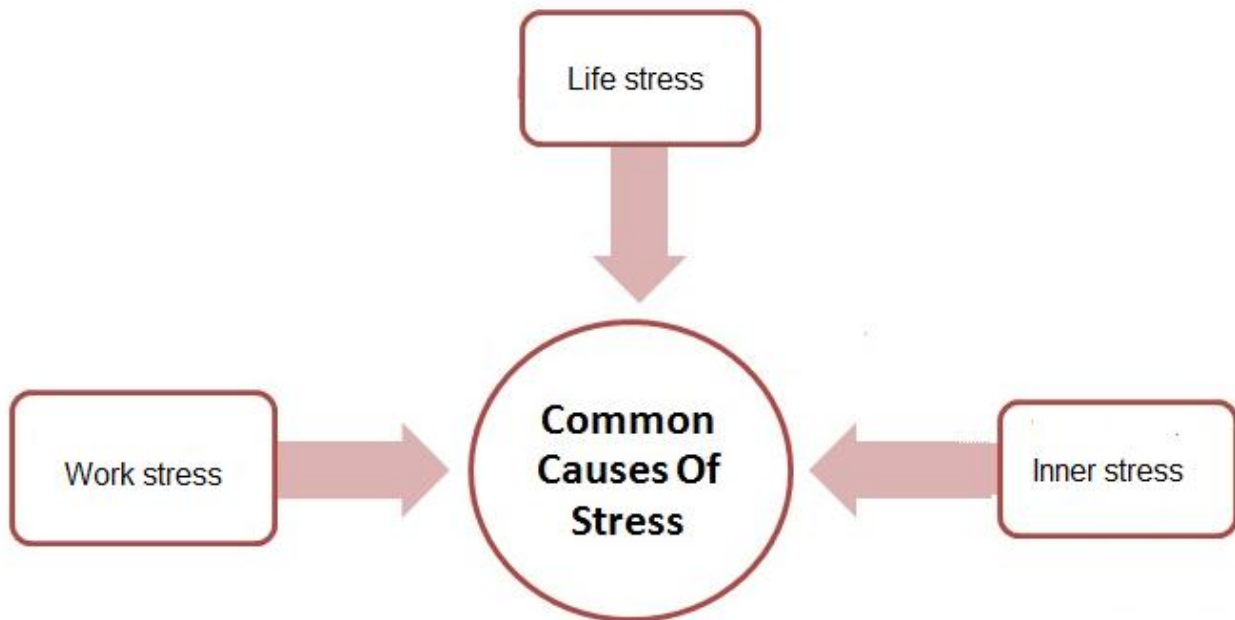


Figure 1.7 – Common Causes Of Stress

2. Effects of Stress on Your Health

2.1 : When you are in a stressful situation, your body launches a physical response. Your nervous system springs into action, releasing hormones that prepare you to either fight or take off. It's called the "fight or flight" response, and it's why, when you're in a stressful situation, you may notice that your heartbeat speeds up, your breathing gets faster, your muscles tense, and you start to sweat. This kind of stress is short-term and temporary (acute stress), and your body usually recovers quickly from it.

2.2 : But if your stress system stays activated over a long period of time (chronic stress), it can lead to more serious health problems. The constant rush of stress hormones can put a lot of wear and tear on your body, causing it to age more quickly and making it more prone to illness.

2.3 : If you've been stressed out for a short period of time, you may start to notice some of these physical signs:

- i) Headache

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- ii) Fatigue
- iii) Difficulty sleeping
- iv) Difficulty concentrating
- v) Upset stomach
- vi) Irritability

2.4 : When stress becomes long-term and is not properly addressed, it can lead to a serious health conditions, including:

- i) Depression
- ii) High blood pressure
- iii) Abnormal heartbeat (arrhythmia)
- iv) Hardening of the arteries (atherosclerosis)
- v) Heart disease
- vi) Heart attack
- vii) Heartburn, ulcers, irritable bowel syndrome
- viii) Upset stomach -- cramps, constipation, and diarrhea
- ix) Weight gain or loss
- x) Changes in sex drive
- xi) Fertility problems
- xii) Flare-ups of asthma or arthritis
- xiii) Skin problems such as acne, eczema, and psoriasis
- xiv) Managing your stress can make a real difference to your health. One study showed that women with heart disease lived longer if they underwent a stress management program.

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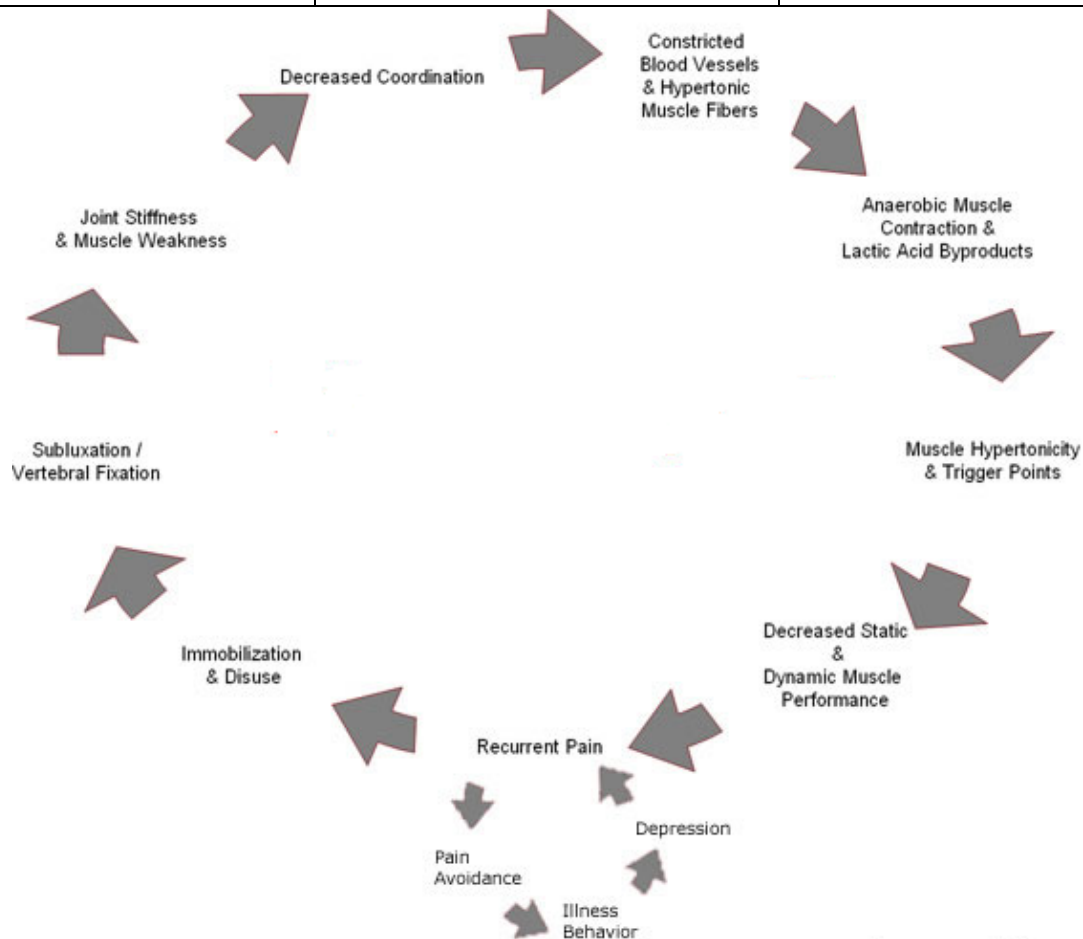


Figure 1 – Stress Cycle Effect

3. Stress Identification

3.1 : At a clinical level, stress in individuals can be assessed scientifically by measuring the levels of two hormones produced by the adrenal glands: cortisol and DHEA (dehydroepiandrosterone).

3.2 : At a workplace, managers do not have access to these methods. Managers must therefore rely on other signs. Some of these are not exclusively due to stress, nor are they certain proof of stress, but they are indicators to prompt investigation as to whether stress is present.

3.3 : There are ten key stress indicators as a simple initial stress test.

- i) Sleep difficulties
- ii) Loss of appetite
- iii) Poor concentration or poor memory retention

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- iv) Performance dip
- v) Uncharacteristic errors or missed deadlines
- vi) Anger or tantrums
- vii) Violent or anti-social behaviour
- viii) Emotional outbursts
- ix) Alcohol or drug abuse
- x) Nervous habits

4. Stress Reduction Techniques

4.1 : The key to de-stressing is removing yourself from the stressor. Developing new habits which regularly remove you and distract you from stressors and stressful situations and pressures is essentially how to manage stress on a more permanent basis.

4.2 : In this modern world it is difficult if not impossible to change stressful situations. What we can do however is change and reduce our exposure to those stressful situations.

4.3 : These stress reduction ideas and techniques are based on simple principle. These techniques won't change the situation causing the stress, but they will, more importantly, enable you to change your reaction and relationship to the stressful situations.

4.4 : There are six quick stress reduction techniques

i) Humour

- a) Humour is one of the greatest and quickest devices for reducing stress.
- b) Humour works because laughter produces helpful chemicals in the brain.
- c) Humour also gets your brain thinking and working in a different way. It distracts you from having a stressed mindset. Distraction is a simple effective de-stressor It takes your thoughts away from the stress, and thereby diffuses the stressful feelings. Therefore most people will feel quite different and notice a change in mindset after laughing and being distracted by something humorous.

ii) Brisk walk and self-talk

- a) Change your environment. Go for a short quick brisk walk outside by leave the workplace building.

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- b) Breathe in some fresh air and smell the atmosphere. Trees, rain, flowers, traffic fumes stimulate your senses with new things.
- c) On your way out keep saying to yourself out loudly.
- d) You can extend the exercise by going to a park and jogging a little or doing something energetic to get your body moving and relaxing.
- e) You can use other mantras or chants, depending on what you want to do and how far you want to get away from the stress causes.
- f) Sometimes the people said this is daft, but the daftness reduces the stress by removing you from the stress in mind and body.

iii) Rehydrate

- a) Get a big cup or a bottle of plain water. Most of us fail to drink enough plain water.
- b) All of your organs, including your brain, are strongly dependent on water to function properly. If you starve, your body will function below your best physically and mentally.
- c) Most of workplaces commonly have a very dry atmosphere due to air conditioning, which increases people's susceptibility to de-hydration.
- d) When you drink lot of water you need to pee. This gives you a bit of a break and a bit of exercise now and then, which also reduces stress.

iv) Catnap or powernap

- a) Take a quick nap. It is nature's way of recharging and re-energising.
A 10-30 minutes' sleep is very helpful to reduce stress.

v) Make a cuppa

- a) Making a cup of hot drink especially tea and coffee take your mind off your problems.

vi) Crying

- a) Crying and weeping proper tears has a powerful helpful effect on stress levels. Sobbing and weeping does seem to release tension and stress for many people.

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SOALAN / QUESTION:

1. What is cause of stress?
2. How stresses can effect the work performance?.
3. How to quick reduce of stress?.

RUJUKAN / REFERENCES:

1. <http://www.webmd.com/balance/guide/causes-of-stress>